

Agilent Technologies Inc. (A): 3Q26 Recap — China Recovery and Advanced Materials Strength Supporting FY26 Guidance Raise

3Q26 revenue of \$1,878mn compared to consensus (FactSet, unless otherwise noted) of \$1,841mn and GSe of \$1,848mn. 3Q non-GAAP EPS of \$1.62 was above consensus and GSe of \$1.49. Agilent reported core revenue growth of 7.3% compared to consensus of 5.4% and GSe of 5.7%.

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Agilent raised FY26 core revenue growth guidance to 5.8% to 6.0% up from 4.5% to 6.0% and raised EPS expectations to \$6.18 to \$6.21 up from \$6.00 to \$6.10, (+\$0.15 at the midpoint). Reported revenue is now expected to be in the range of \$7.49bn to \$7.51bn (vs. previous expectations of \$7.39bn to \$7.49bn, up \$60mn at midpoint) to account for a 1.6% FX tailwind vs. prior assumptions of a 1.8% FX tailwind and 65bps of core revenue growth guidance increase at the midpoint. Additionally, management maintained its operating cash flow guidance of \$1.6bn to \$1.7bn

For 4Q26, Agilent expects revenue in the range of \$1.98bn to \$2.00bn (vs. prior GSe and consensus of \$1.97bn), reflective of a 0.1% headwind from FX and core revenue growth of 5.2% to 6.2%. Additionally, Agilent expects EPS in the range of \$1.71 to \$1.74 for 4Q26, roughly in line with prior GSe and consensus of \$1.72.

Executive Summary

What You Need to Know: Agilent's 3Q organic growth of 7.3% came in ahead of the top end of their guidance range of 4.4%-5.9% for the quarter, with the beat largely driven by the Pharma and Chemical & Advanced Materials end markets, as well as China which posted 9% growth, compared to guidance of flat. The Advanced Therapeutics Business (Agilent's CDMO) grew 30% in the quarter, with management highlighting strong demand moving forward, despite recent noise from key customers. Agilent raised FY26 core revenue growth guide by 65bps, at the mid point flowing through the 3Q beat and increasing implied 4Q expectations by ~20bps. Operating margins also came in above expectations, reporting +80bps ahead of implied guidance.

Bottom line: Leading up to the print, questions from investors were largely focused on growth in the NASD portion of the Advanced Therapeutics business and the 3Q to 4Q sequential margin ramp implied in guide. We believe the positive commentary around Advanced Therapeutics demand into 2027, and the derisked 4Q margin ramp should lead to increased comfort around these key focus areas. We continue to

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believe the company is poised to benefit from several growth drivers next year including 1) the continued LC replacement cycle, 2) ramp up of the GC replacement cycle, 3) reshoring within Pharma and Advanced Materials, and 4) increased capacity within their Advanced Therapeutics business.

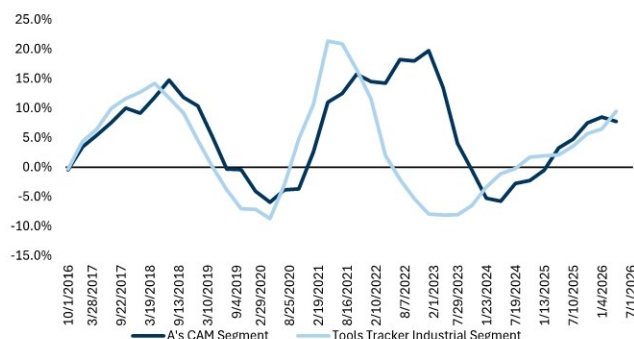
Takeaways

- **Advanced Therapeutics:** The Advanced Therapeutics division (ATD), Agilent's CDMO business which includes NASD and Biovectra, reported growth of ~30% in 3Q, which was largely in line with expectations, but represented a significant acceleration from 2Q results of +HSD%. In 4Q26, this business is expected to be ~flat, as it faces a tough 40% comp, implying full year growth of ~12-13%. Growth in the fourth quarter is somewhat dependent on several regulatory submissions from customers which are expected in the later half of the quarter, leading to a level of uncertainty on timing that is largely outside of A's control. Taking a step back, the company struck a positive tone on the levels of demand for their CDMO services over the mid-term, which we view as especially important given additional capacity which is expected to come online in Spring of 2027 (Train C) and already has ~75% of available capacity booked. Additionally, while investor concerns leading into the quarter surrounded a key customer who lowered FY26 guidance (*see our team's ALNY earnings recap [here](#)*), we note that this customer represents <20% of NASD revenue and <1% of total Agilent revenue, with a guidance cut of only ~4%, and thus we do not expect this dynamic to have a material impact on 2026 or 2027 results.
- **Chemicals and Advanced Materials:** The Chemical and Advanced Materials (CAM) end market came in ahead of expectations, reporting growth of 7% in 3Q. This consisted of double-digit growth in Advanced Materials and LSD growth in Chemical & Energy, which lapped a tough YoY compare. The Advanced Materials business benefits from ongoing trends in semiconductor manufacturing including reshoring and AI infrastructure build outs, with the semi end market representing ~3-4% of Agilent's total revenue. While Chemical & Energy decelerated slightly QoQ (down from MSD growth in 2Q26), the company called out both a tougher comp and a slight downturn in EMEA and specialty Chemical related to geopolitical disruption. Overall, we continue to believe that as the company benefits from the ramp up of the Gas Chromatography (GC) replacement cycle and durable growth drivers in Advanced Materials, they will see a ramp up of growth in this segment which has historically tracked our GS Tools Tracker Industrial Segment Data ([Exhibit 1](#)). We also note that the company raised their 2026 guidance for this end market, now expecting growth of HSD, from previous of MSD-HSD.
- **China:** China accelerated significantly QoQ, posting growth of 9% in 3Q, well ahead of previous guidance of ~flat. Management highlighted strength in several end markets including Pharma and Food, with limited impact related to stimulus, highlighting the more durable nature of the growth. Within Pharma, they saw benefits related to increased investment from Global Pharma companies into local biotech innovations, which has driven strong demand from CxO (CRO and CDMO) customers. They also highlighted a key competitive win within a leading commercial

testing lab within the PFAS testing market. These growth drivers led the company to increase their FY26 guide for China to be +MSD, up from previous full year guide of flat. We believe this is particularly encouraging as China has historically represented an accretive growth driver for the Tools space broadly, and more recent trends point to potential return to this dynamic over time.

Exhibit 1: GS Tools Tracker Industrial estimates act as a leading indicator for A's CAM segment

4-Quarter Rolling Average



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Agilent 2026 Guidance by Segment

A 2026 Segment Guidance		
Segment	Previous	Current
LDG	+MSD	+MSD-HSD
AMG	+MSD	+MSD-HSD
ACG	+MSD	+MSD
End Market	Previous	Current
Pharma	+HSD	+HSD
Dx & Clinical	+MSD-HSD	+MSD-HSD
A&G	-LSD	-LSD
CAM	+MSD-HSD	+HSD
Env. & Forensics	+LSD-MSD	+LSD-MSD
Food	-LSD	-LSD

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Changes to GS Estimates

	2026E	2027E	2028E
Net Sales			
Current	\$7,501	\$8,007	\$8,496
Previous	\$7,450	\$7,943	\$8,432
EBIT Margin			
Current	27.0%	27.5%	28.3%
Previous	26.5%	27.4%	28.1%
EPS			
Current	\$6.20	\$6.68	\$7.49
Previous	\$6.06	\$6.71	\$7.53
Total Company Organic Growth			
Current	5.9%	6.3%	6.1%
Previous	5.5%	6.5%	6.2%
LDG Organic Growth			
Current	6.6%	6.4%	6.0%
Previous	5.9%	6.6%	6.1%
AMG Organic Growth			
Current	7.0%	5.9%	5.3%
Previous	6.1%	5.7%	5.3%
ACG Organic Growth			
Current	4.9%	6.3%	6.5%
Previous	4.8%	6.8%	6.5%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We raise our Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA target multiple to 20x from 19x after refreshing comps and raise our 12-month target price to \$175 from \$155 to reflect rolled forward estimates.

We are Buy rated on A. Our 12-month price target is \$175. Our valuation methodology uses a target 20x Q5-Q8 EV/EBITDA. Key risks include (1) incremental spending weakness from large pharma, should additional MFN deals not materialize, which may drive reduced capex investments, leading to a shorter than expected instrument replacement cycle, (2) within A's China exposure local competition could displace Agilent or various negative geopolitical implications could create headwinds to growth, (3) incremental global macro weakness may put pressure on our favorable view around a cyclical upswing for A's Applied end market, and (4) weakness in NASD and further cancellations in siRNA/mRNA may drive outsized lumpiness in our organic growth assumptions.

A	12m Price Target: \$175.00	Price: \$155.08	Upside: 12.8%
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Buy		GS Forecast				
Market cap: \$43.9bn Enterprise value: \$45.8bn 3m ADTV: \$317.0mn United States Americas Life Sciences Tools, Diagnostics & CROs M&A Rank: 3		10/25	10/26E	10/27E	10/28E	
	Revenue (\$ mn) New	6,948.0	7,500.8	8,006.9	8,496.4	
	Revenue (\$ mn) Old	6,948.0	7,450.0	7,943.1	8,432.0	
	EBITDA (\$ mn)	1,962.2	2,184.4	2,434.8	2,577.8	
	EBIT (\$ mn)	1,783.0	2,022.6	2,202.6	2,400.8	
	EPS (\$ New)	5.58	6.20	6.68	7.49	
	EPS (\$ Old)	5.58	6.06	6.71	7.53	
	P/E (X)	22.6	25.0	23.2	20.7	
	Dividend yield (%)	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.7	
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	0.8	0.9	0.5	0.2	
		7/26	10/26E	1/27E	4/27E	
	EPS (\$)	1.62	1.72	1.44	1.59	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 26 Aug 2026 close.

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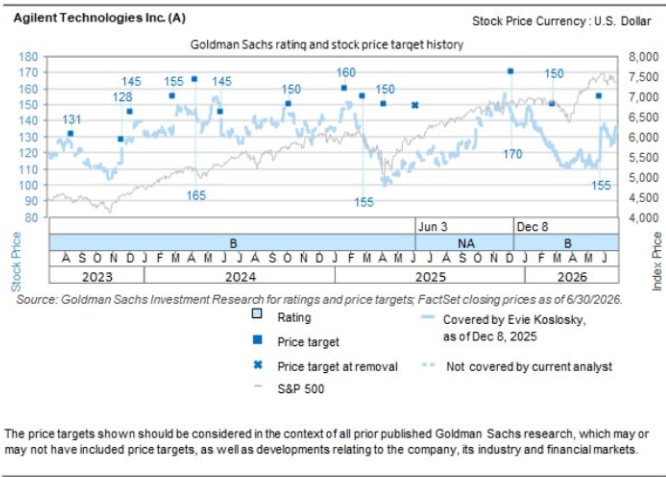
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Target price history table(s)
Agilent Technologies Inc. (A)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
28-May-26	155.00	135.38
26-Feb-26	150.00	120.97
09-Dec-25	170.00	140.64
08-Apr-25	150.00	99.29
27-Feb-25	155.00	127.08
23-Jan-25	160.00	152.45
08-Oct-24	150.00	144.61
30-May-24	145.00	131.42
09-Apr-24	165.00	147.40
28-Feb-24	155.00	137.01
07-Dec-23	145.00	128.68
21-Nov-23	128.00	123.92

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